

Topic 5 – Urban Futures

Never before has the landscape of the planet looked more urban. Cities are growing at unprecedented rates. This topic seeks to explore why, and consider how the global pattern of urbanisation is changing. Urban challenges and opportunities are varied and unique and learners will examine these through studying two cities, one from an advanced country

(AC) and one from either an emerging and developing country (EDC) or a low-income developing country (LIDC). Within each city, contrasting ways of life, geographical processes, problems and solutions will be studied in order to gain a holistic understanding of what makes up the urban fabric of each place.

5.1. Why do more than half the world's population live in urban areas?		Scale
a. How is the global pattern of urbanisation changing?	• How urban growth rates vary in parts of the world with contrasting levels of development.	G
	• Outline characteristics of world cities and megacities and their changing distribution since 1950.	G
b. What does rapid urbanisation mean for cities?	• Understand the causes of rapid urbanisation in LIDCs, including the push and pull factors of rural-urban migration and internal growth.	G, R, N, L
	• Investigate the consequences of rapid urban growth in LIDCs. • Understand the causes and consequences of contrasting urban trends in ACs, including suburbanisation, counter-urbanisation and re-urbanisation.	N, L

5.2. What are the challenges and opportunities for cities today?

This enquiry question is studied through **case studies** of **one** city in an AC and **one** city in an LIDC or EDC to answer sub-questions a and b.

a. What is life like for people in a city?	• The city's location and importance within its region, the country, and the wider world. • Patterns of national and international migration and how this is changing the growth and character of the city. • Explore the ways of life in the city, such as culture, ethnicity, housing, leisure and consumption. • Investigate the contemporary challenges that affect life in the AC city, such as housing availability, transport provision, access to services and inequality. • Investigate the contemporary challenges that affect life in the LIDC or EDC city, such as informal settlements, informal sector jobs, health or waste disposal.	G, R, N, L, F
b. How can cities become more sustainable?	• For each city investigate one initiative to make it more sustainable, such as use of brownfield sites, waste recycling and transport improvements.	L, F